

Assignment: Convert Census “Tally Sheet” Data into Population Totals for Needed Categories

Problem Overview: As part of our R programming project, we are attempting to track and explain population migration from large cities to nearby suburban and rural locations across America during the years 1990-2001. We are also attempting to identify the specific locations (and types of places) that residents moved toward and why people are left.

Subtask Goal: Using R, convert the census data "tally sheet" file into an analytic file that could be used in long panel (longitudinal panel) data format. The data must be aggregated to the county-level so each county has only a single row of data for the year 1990.

Key Steps:

- 1) Download the file to be converted: On OneDrive, locate the "School Project R" folder. Next, under "Census_Population," download the file "icen1990.xlsx".
- 2) Create Needed Variables:
 - a) A total population count (i.e. for the whole county).
 - b) Population counts for three (3) different demographic groups by county:
 - 1) Counts of nonhispanic White residents.
 - 2) Counts of Nonwhite residents (for all other race/ethnicities).
 - 3) Subgroup population counts for 3 age groups (0-29, 30-59, 60+).